

In the last week I finally feel like I am getting my head back on straight for the first time since Christmas.

I'm not sure what the fix was but

I imagine that each of these help

• Finn

• Exercising marginally more often

• End in sight for this metatheory project

• Voicing my emotional exhaustion and externally lamenting a lack of

innocence / familial safety blanket

• Engaging in hobbies like being a vike coding king

In any case, it's been nice.

I also think that I've been understanding more the ways in which I was a horrible partner to Maria while we were together.

The effects of my inattentiveness really put a

strain on not only a relationship

romantically, but also in a partnership.

Even after the romantic ship had sailed,

I was dead weight as a caretaker to

Olive.

Maybe Finn's presence has me realizing

the weight of caring for a funny little

creature, and I'm realizing that I wasn't

much of a parent to Olive. I was a

burden to be managed. I was a scared

sniffles child w/ a Golden Retriever as

a best friend, not a level-headed adult

who was equipped to care for her — or

to viscerally understand the weight of

a marriage for that matter.

I understand even more now how

unequipped I really was for the whole

situation, and I empathize a lot more

w/ Maria the more I reflect on things.

I don't think she's evil by any means.

Anything comparable to having my partner

lose their mother, who I loved as well,

at such a young age, or having my

sister-in-law inflicting her undiagnosed

personality disorder on my environment;

either of these would surely drive me

crazy. Probably even crazier than Maria

was, more so that she was crazy at all.

In retrospect, I think she was doing what

she could. Perhaps that wasn't enough

and never could be, and maybe that's

okay.

My lizard brain wants so badly to sort

things into us v. them, hero v. villain, etc.

I don't see how that can really apply here.

I tried to hate her, and I ended not

w/ disdain but with apathy. I came away

w/ a deep-seated belief that I can

not live a full life w/ her as my wife.

This was known to me after being married,

and it is probably why my eyes strayed so

easily.

So if she isn't the villain, my instincts

say that it must be me. I've put a lot of

work into trying to forgive myself and

give grace for the confounding emotional

nightmare of losing Thom.

Some days I even believe that I am not

evil for what has transpired in my love

life.

I don't even know what I'm on about

anymore. I think I want to say

genuinely to Maria that I'm sorry and

that I am very grateful for the time

together in our lives. I am sure that

it doesn't look like that externally, but

I do truly mean it. I don't know

precisely when, but one day a switch

flipped and our love became obligation and

duty, not joy, passion, or desire. I think

some couples can make that work, but

they shouldn't have to. Especially when so

young and wrapped up in grief.

Being in this dutiful arrangement I knew

was unhealthy and unsustainable,

and I didn't know how to de-escalate

or fix it. There's no return from

marriage that isn't a damaging divorce.

There was no real solution. We could've

learned to love each other again, but

that's not any way to begin your life-long

marriage. That's a tool for the old folks,

for those saddled w/ kids.

I knew that the only real path forward

was a breakup and I couldn't admit it

to myself or to you. I couldn't own my

emotions enough. I couldn't be kind

enough to give you a moment of

cruelty and honesty. Instead I drove

you to look into my journal and

stumble upon the unholy truth for

yourself, and for that I am so

deeply regretful. I owed that to you.

As my wife, as my friend and partner,

I owed you the truth.

Rachel defended today and her and

Preet did the "doctor" and Doctor

routine. It made me think of you.

As much as I don't want to be your husband,

I do wish I could be your friend in some

capacity, but, I don't think that's how

these things work.

If for nothing else, I wish I could've seen

you finish med school. You sacrificed so

much to succeed there. Some may even

say you sacrificed our relationship.

In a paradoxical way that makes me

wish that I could've seen that it

was worth it in some sense. Maybe

that's a fucked way to view things

and I don't really believe it. I talk

that's all to say, I'm sorry then. I

sincerely hope you're doing well and

find happiness, whatever that looks like

for you. And it almost certainly doesn't

look like what you thought it did

when you were 18. Please listen to what

you are actually feeling and adjust

accordingly. Despite the loss and turmoil

getting here, that's what I've tried to do

and I think it's worth it. I feel

like I am living as earnestly as I can.

I am trying to trust my gut, as it knows

things that I don't. If there were any

lesson in this world to learn from our time

together it is that the gut can't be

ignored. It'll come back around one

way or another.

I really ought to start journaling

regularly again.